

Unity Brass

Executive Summary

Client

Barbara Folb

Student Consulting Team

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Background

Unity Brass is a self-funded, Pittsburgh-based brass ensemble founded in 2018 with a mission to share accessible, uplifting music with the community. The ensemble consists of a small group of musicians and performs at recitals, community events, and special occasions throughout the year. Unity Brass primarily promotes performances and communicates with audiences through its website, word-of-mouth, and music-focused newsletters. The organization operates with a lightweight technology ecosystem centered around a hand-coded HTML website, along with tools such as Google Calendar, Google Sheets, and email for communication and coordination.

Project Description

Project Opportunity

Unity Brass faced challenges with how information was presented and managed across its systems. The website did not fully reflect the ensemble's current identity, and event information required manual updates to the codespace, creating inefficiencies. Additionally, media and press materials were distributed across separate platforms, making it difficult to share information efficiently with external audiences. These challenges created an opportunity to improve both the website and the underlying workflows while maintaining a simple and sustainable system.

Project Vision

The project vision was to design and implement a redesigned website that improves Unity Brass's professional representation while remaining easy to maintain and aligned with existing workflows. The solution focuses on improving content clarity, usability, and organization, while integrating existing tools to reduce manual effort and ensure long-term sustainability without introducing unnecessary complexity.

Project Outcomes

The project resulted in a redesigned website and improved information management workflow that enhanced both internal operations and external communication. The new system reduces reliance on manual processes by introducing Google Sheets as a centralized location for event data, eliminating the risk of duplicate data entry and significantly reducing update time. The website was rebuilt using structured HTML and CSS with improved navigation and mobile responsiveness, and automatically displays event information in a clear and organized format. Media and content are also more consistently structured, making it easier for both members and external users to access key information. Overall, the solution improves efficiency, consistency, and usability while remaining sustainable within Unity Brass's existing technical and financial constraints.

Project Deliverables

The final deliverables include a fully redesigned and publicly accessible website, a source code repository, and documentation detailing how to update content and manage the event system through Google Sheets. The team also provided design wireframes, and a training session to ensure the client can independently maintain the website moving forward.

Recommendations

The team recommends that Unity Brass continue using Google Sheets as a centralized document for event management to maintain efficiency and consistency. The organization should also regularly update website content to ensure accuracy and engagement. Improving social media pages to better reflect the ensemble's work and link back to the website can further enhance outreach. Finally, Unity Brass may consider future enhancements, such as event filtering or additional usability features, as organizational needs evolve.

Team Member Bios

Ruhani Patel is a junior studying Information Systems with minors in Product Management and Human-Computer Interaction, graduating in 2027. She served as the Client Relationship Manager and led communication with Unity Brass.

Zoe Robinson is a junior studying Information Systems with a concentration in Product Management, graduating in 2027. She served as the Project Manager and managed timelines, deliverables, and design direction.

Rong Yuan is a senior double majoring in Information Systems and Human-Computer Interaction, graduating in 2026. She served as the Technical Lead and was responsible for development, testing, and deployment of the website.